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Wright et al.

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(54) **BLUEBERRY PLANT NAMED ‘C04-051’**

(50) Latin Name: *Vaccinium corymbosum* hybrid
Varietal Denomination: **C04-051**

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of blueberry (*Vaccinium corym-*
bosum hybrid) plant named ‘C04-051’, characterized by its
Upright to semi-upright plant growth habit and strong plant
growth vigor, low chilling requirement, large fruit size, good
fruit flavor, firm fruit suited to handling and low scarring on
the fruit. This combination results in higher quality fruit with
a later availability than other varieties.

4 Drawing Sheets

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Latin name of the family, genus, and species:

Family—Ericaceae.

Genus—*Vaccinium*.

Species—*corymbosum* hybrid.

Variety denomination: The new blueberry plant claimed is 5
of the variety denominated ‘C04-051’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct peren- 10
nial variety of *Vaccinium corymbosum* hybrid (blueberry),
which has been given the variety denomination of ‘C04-051’.
The new variety ‘C04-051’ shows distinctive traits such as
strong growth vigor, good acidity and sweetness balance in
the fruit, low scarring strong fruit firmness, low chilling
requirement. The new variety ‘C04-051’ is intended for use as
fresh fruit for shipping, customer pick and processing mar-
kets and as a home garden plant.

The new blueberry cultivar is a selection resulting from 20
seedlings produced in a controlled breeding programme of
Vaccinium varieties in Florida, USA in 2002 from a cross of
the blueberry variety known as ‘FL02-043’ (seed parent)
(unpatented) and the blueberry variety known as ‘FL89-119’
(pollen parent) (unpatented). The seed from the cross was
sown and grown in Corindi Beach, New South Wales, Aus-
tralia. The new cultivar was discovered and selected in 2004
as a single plant within a population of seedlings resulted
from the controlled cross, in an experimental block in the field
at Corindi Beach, New South Wales, Australia, and has since 30
been named ‘C04-051’. Selection criteria were a combination
of strong growth vigor, low chilling requirement, good fruit
flavor and low scarring on the fruit. The new variety was

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subsequently evaluated for a number of years at the commer-
cial farm at Corindi Beach, New South Wales, Australia.

Asexual reproduction of the new variety ‘C04-051’ by
softwood cutting propagation since 2004 at Corindi Beach,
New South Wales, Australia has demonstrated that the new
variety reproduces true to type with all of the characteristics,
as herein described, firmly fixed and retained through succes-
sive generations of such asexual propagation, with the clones
phenotypically identical to the original plant.

The seed parent ‘FL02-043’ is characterized by an upright 10
growth habit and late timing ripening of fruit. The pollen
parent ‘FL89-119’ is characterized by medium plant growth
vigor, early timing of ripening of fruit and semi-upright
growth habit. The new variety ‘C04-051’ differs from the 15
female parent ‘FL02-043’ and the male parent ‘FL89-119’ in
that ‘C04-051’ has a mid-season cropping timing. The new
variety ‘C04-051’ has a plant growth habit that is intermediate
between the female parent’s upright and the male parent’s
semi-upright growth habit. The new variety ‘C04-051’ also 20
differs from the male parent in that ‘C04-051’ has stronger
plant vigor.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The following characteristics of the new variety have been 25
repeatedly observed and can be used to distinguish ‘C04-051’
as a new and distinct variety of *Vaccinium corymbosum*
hybrid:

1. Low chilling requirement
2. Strong growth vigor
3. Upright to semi-upright plant growth habit
4. Large fruit size

5. Good fruit flavor

6. Low scarring on the fruit

The new variety 'C04-051' differs from the female parent 'FL02-043' and the male parent 'FL89-119' in that 'C04-051' has a mid-season cropping timing. The new variety 'C04-051' has a plant growth habit that is intermediate between the female parent's upright and the male parent's semi-upright growth habit. The new variety 'C04-051' also differs from the male parent in that 'C04-051' has stronger plant vigor. The new blueberry variety 'C04-051' has maintained its distinguished characteristics throughout successive asexual propagation.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

The accompanying photographic illustration shows typical specimens in full color of the foliage and fruit of the new variety 'C04-051'. The colors are as nearly true as is reasonably possible in a color representation of this type.

FIG. 1 is a photograph of the new variety 'C04-051' demonstrating the plant's upright to semi-upright growth habit.

FIG. 2 is a photograph of the flowers of the new variety 'C04-051'.

FIG. 3 is a photograph of the fruit of the new variety 'C04-051'.

FIG. 4 is a photograph of the new variety 'C04-051', showing parts of the plant in comparison with 3 other varieties.

The colors in the photographs are as close as possible with the photographic and printing technology utilized. The color values cited in the detailed botanical description accurately describe the colors of the new blueberry.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The following detailed description sets forth the distinctive characteristics of 'C04-051'. The data which defines these characteristics was collected from asexual reproductions of the original selection. Dimensions, sizes, colors, and other characteristics are approximations and averages set forth as accurately as possible. The plant history was taken on plants approximately 4 years of age, and the descriptions relate to plants grown in the field in Corindi Beach, New South Wales, Australia. Descriptions of fruit characteristics were made on fruit grown in Corindi Beach, New South Wales, Australia. Color designations are from R.H.S. Chart—edition 2007.

Classification:

Family.—Ericaceae.

Genus.—*Vaccinium*.

Species.—*corymbosum* hybrid.

Common name.—blueberry.

Parentage:

Seed parent.—'FL02-043' (unpatented).

Pollen parent.—'FL89-119' (unpatented).

Market class: Suitable for the Commercial, Hand Harvest Fresh, Processed, and Home Garden Markets.

PLANT

Parentage.—'FL02-043'×'FL89-119'.

Growth habit.—Upright to semi-upright.

Growth.—Vigorous.

Chilling requirement.—Low chill.

Leafing.—Moderate during the winter and medium to high during the summer under the environment at Corindi Beach, NSW, Australia.

FOLIAGE

Time of beginning of leaf bud burst.—Around middle August.

Leaf color (top side).—Near to green group 137 A and the vein color near to green group N144 A.

Leaf shape.—Elliptic.

Leaf margins.—Entire.

Leaf length.—Average 65 mm (range 58-75 mm).

Leaf width.—Average 35 mm (29-42 mm).

Leaf nectarines.—Absent.

Petioles:

a. Length.—Average 3.8 mm (range 2.4-5 mm).

FLOWERS

Time of beginning of flowering.—Medium around middle August.

Time of 50% anthesis.—Average 15th August.

Corolla:

a. Length.—Average 6.4 mm (range 5.2-8.1 mm).

b. Anthocyanin coloration of corolla.—Absent.

FRUIT

Time of fruit ripening.—Medium.

Unripe fruit color.—Near to yellow-green group 145B.

Ripe berry color.—Near to Blue group 103A.

Berry surface wax abundance.—Strong to very strong.

Berry weight.—Average 2.8 g.

Berry diameter.—Average 17 mm (range 16.3-18.3 mm).

Fruit stem scar.—Dry, average 2 mm (range 1.6-2.5 mm).

Sweetness when ripe.—Medium (average 14 Brix).

Uses.—Fresh fruit.

SEED

Seed abundance in fruit.—Ranging between 3-11 viable seeds.

Seed length.—Average 2.1 mm (range 1.8-2.3 mm).

The invention claimed is:

1. A new and distinct variety of blueberry plant named 'C04-051', substantially as illustrated and described herein.

* * * * *



FIG.1



FIG. 2



FIG.3

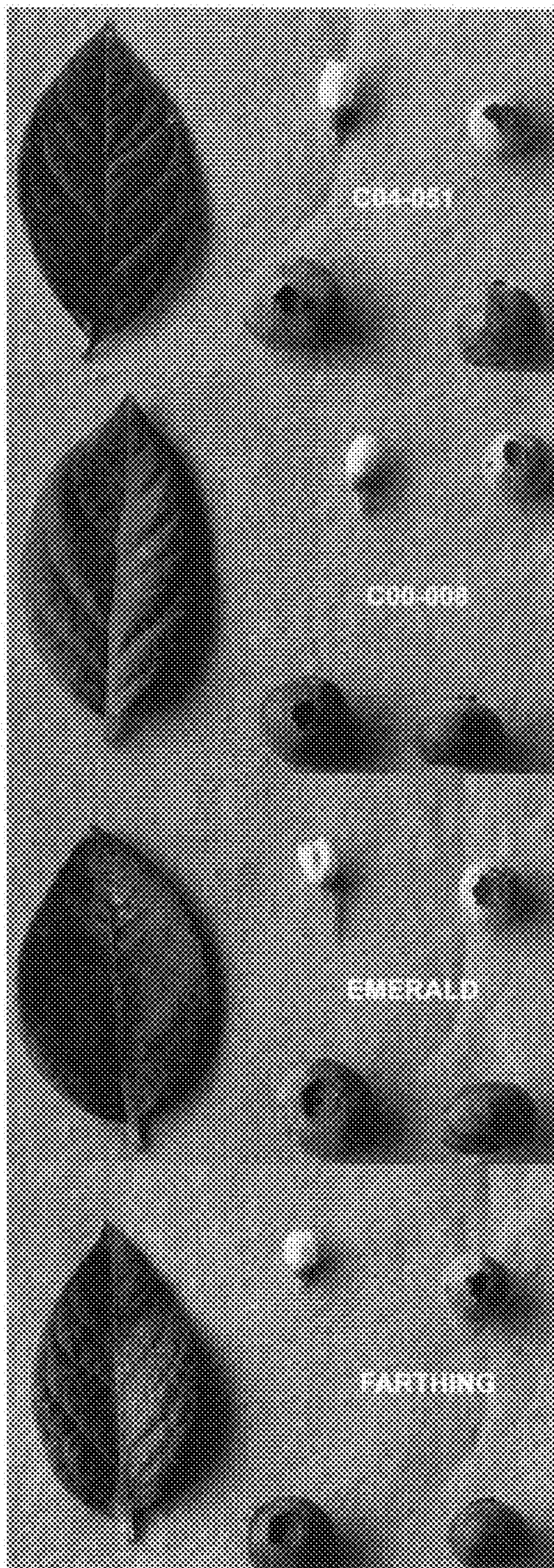


FIG.4